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A PIECE OF STRING

UNIT 3 CHAPTER 3

 **Write up**

In 'A Piece of String' Hauchecome dies in shame and humiliation because of the attitude of society. Prepare a write-up on how society can make or break an individual, drawing on the story and your personal knowledge and experience.

In the story A Piece of String, Hauchecome is wrongly accused of stealing a lost wallet just because he was seen picking up a piece of string. Even after the wallet is found and returned by someone else, people continue to doubt him. They laugh at him, mock him, and refuse to believe his side of the story. Hauchecome tries again and again to prove his innocence, but the society around him refuses to listen. This constant suspicion and humiliation break his spirit, and he dies in pain and shame.

This story shows how society's attitude can deeply affect a person's life. When people judge without proof or spread false ideas, it can destroy someone's peace of mind. Hauchecome was an honest man, but the community's refusal to believe him made him feel helpless and alone. Even when the truth came out, the damage was already done. Society has the power to lift someone up with kindness and support, or to crush them with doubt and cruelty.

In real life too, we see how people are affected by what others think and say. A person's reputation can be ruined by gossip or misunderstanding. It is important to be fair, to listen, and to give others a chance to explain. We must remember that our words and actions can either heal or hurt. Just like Hauchecome, many people suffer silently because they are not believed or

respected. As members of society, we should choose to be kind and just, so that we help others grow instead of breaking them.

Character sketch of Hauchecome

Hauchecome is an old peasant from the village of Goderville, described as simple and practical, who believes in picking up anything useful, like a piece of string. He is honest and hardworking but also sensitive and proud, especially when seen by his enemy Malandain. His main motivation is to protect his reputation and prove his innocence after being wrongly accused of stealing a lost pocketbook. Throughout the story, he remains the same—truthful and determined—but the constant disbelief and mockery from others slowly break his spirit. His relationship with others is strained, especially with Malandain, who falsely accuses him, and with the villagers who laugh at him. Hauchecome's character highlights the theme of how society's harsh judgment can destroy an innocent person. His repeated efforts to explain himself, his emotional breakdown, and his final words before death—"A piece of string"—show how deeply the false accusation affected him.

Character sketch of Malandain

Malandain is a harness-maker in the town of Goderville, and though his physical appearance is not described in detail, he is shown as observant and quick to judge. He is a suspicious and unfriendly man, especially toward Hauchecome, with whom he shares a bitter relationship. When he sees Hauchecome picking up a piece of string, he wrongly assumes it is the lost pocketbook and reports it to the Mayor. His actions seem to be driven by personal dislike and a desire to harm Hauchecome's reputation. Malandain does not change throughout the story; he remains firm in his false accusation even after the truth is revealed. His relationship with Hauchecome is marked by hostility and mistrust. Malandain's role is central to the story's theme of how false judgment and social cruelty can destroy an innocent person. His false claim and refusal to admit his mistake lead to Hauchecome's suffering and eventual death, showing how dangerous and damaging a lie can be when supported by pride and prejudice.

diary

Hauchecome is devastated when he is falsely accused of stealing the pocketbook. No one believes him. He couldn't control his emotions. He pours out his feelings in his diary. Prepare the likely diary entry.

18 October 2025, Saturday
Evening, 8:15 PM

What a dreadful day

I can't pen down my emotions... From the first light of dawn, everything felt normal, but events took an unexpected turn even God couldn't predict. I picked up a piece of string, just a habit, nothing more, and suddenly I was accused of stealing a pocketbook. Life paused for a second when the Mayor looked at me with suspicion. I was shocked... paralysed... To be honest, I didn't know what to do. Amidst the chaos, I tried to explain, showed the string, turned my pockets inside out, but no one believed me. Strap in, diary, because here comes the emotional rollercoaster—laughter, mockery, shame... I hated it when they called me a liar. Exhausted... worn out... I kept repeating the truth, but they only laughed louder. In the quietness of the evening, I feel broken. Just a piece of string... and yet it crushed me.

 **Letter**

Hauchecome was worried deeply after he was accused by the mayor, he was very depressed and decided to write a letter to his friend describing his mental agony.

Ivy Dale
Green valley
Goderville
25th Nov 2025

Dear Friend,

I hope you are doing well. I am writing this letter with a heavy heart. Something terrible happened to me at the market in Goderville. I was wrongly accused of stealing a pocketbook, and I cannot bear the shame.

I only picked up a small piece of string from the road. Malandain saw me and told the Mayor that I took the lost pocketbook. I tried to explain, but no one believed me. Even after the pocketbook was found and returned by someone else, people still laughed at me. They think I made someone return it for me. I feel helpless and broken. My name and honour are ruined.

I do not know how to live with this pain. I keep telling the truth, but it does not matter anymore. I feel alone and ashamed. I just wanted to share my sorrow with you. Please pray for me.

**Yours Lovingly
Sd/-
Hauchecome**

 **Conversation**

The news of the missing pocketbook spreads like wildfire and Hauchecome is seen as the likely thief. You are an inhabitant of Goderville and you come across Hauchecome on your way to the market. Prepare the likely conversation between you and Hauchecome.

Johns: Hello Mr Hauchecome, How are you?

Houchecome: I'm not fine

Johns: oh what happened to you dear.

Houchecome: People are treating me very badly.

Johns: why, why were they treating you badly?

Houchecome: They are spreading news that I took the missing pocket book.

Johns: Did you take the pocket book ?

Houchecome: No, never, I took only a piece of string.

Johns: Who reported that you took the pocket book ?

Houchecome: Malandain

Johns: you had better deny the argument

Houchecome: I have already denied it 10 times but no use.

Johns: God will find a way. I will catch you later.

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 **Email**

After Hauchecome dies, the Mayor appears deeply remorseful and troubled. He writes an email of condolence to Hauchcome's wife.

From:mayor@gmail.com

To: houchecome@gmail.com

Date: 25 Nov 2025

Subject: Heartfelt Condolences

Dear Madam,

I am deeply sorry for the loss of your husband, Monsieur Hauchecome. His passing has left me troubled and full of regret.

I now understand the pain he suffered because of the misunderstanding. I wish I had listened more carefully and acted with kindness. Please accept my sincere apology.

Your husband was a good man. May his soul rest in peace. I pray for strength and comfort for you and your family.

With respect,

The Mayor

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